

Dusty the Donkey's Long Ears

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Dusty was a small gray donkey. He lived on a sunny hillside farm. Dusty had very long ears. Longer than any donkey around. They flopped when he walked. Flop flop. They bounced when he trotted. Bounce bounce. The other animals teased him gently. "Watch out for those ears!" laughed the goat. Dusty felt embarrassed. He tried to hold his ears still. But they flopped anyway. He felt sad. "I wish my ears were short," he sighed.



One windy night, Dusty could not sleep. The wind howled through the hills. Whoooo! It sounded scary. Dusty hid under his blanket. His long ears poked out. Then he heard something else. Very faint. Very sweet. It was his friend Basil the barn mouse. She was singing a lullaby. But she was far away. Too far for short ears to hear. Dusty heard every word. His long ears caught the song. La la, sleep now, la la. Dusty felt amazed. His long ears were like super ears! He felt special. He felt grateful.



The next morning, Dusty told Basil. "Your long ears heard my song?" squeaked Basil. "Every word," said Dusty proudly. Basil smiled. "Then remember this," she said. "Long ears hear the sweetest songs." "Long ears hear the sweetest songs." Dusty repeated it happily. "Long ears hear the sweetest songs." It became his proud saying. "Long ears hear the sweetest songs."



That evening, Basil sang again. Dusty listened with his long ears. La la, sleep now, la la. He heard the crickets too. He heard the owl's soft hoot. He heard the breeze in the grass. So many sweet songs! Dusty had the best ears on the farm. He did not wish for short ears anymore. He loved his long ears. Flop flop, bounce bounce. They were perfect.



Can you listen like Dusty? Cup your hands behind your ears. Now listen for the sweetest sound. What do you hear? Dusty shared his gift. He told the goat about the owl's song. He told the chickens about the cricket choir. Everyone wanted long-ears listening lessons. Dusty taught them all. "Cup your ears and listen," he said. The farm became a listening farm. Everyone heard sweet songs.



That night, Dusty curled in his straw. Basil sang her lullaby. La la, sleep now, la la. Dusty's long ears caught every note. "Long ears hear the sweetest songs," he yawned. The wind was gentle now. The stars twinkled softly. And Dusty slept, listening to sweet dreams.

Moral: *What makes you different might be your greatest gift.*

The End